

Catedral Metropolitana de Santiago

Location Santiago, Spain

Structurally, the Romanesque origins of the Catedral Metropolitana de Santiago are unmistakable. However, decoratively, especially externally, the building displays 18th-century Churrigueresque detailing—a form of elaborate decoration popularized by the Churriguera family from Barcelona. The essential elements favored by the Churrigueresque are more or less Classical, but their impact is not, and any discordance generated by clashes between styles is simply ignored. There is an array of intricate detailing. The skyline of the main facade—a central lantern flanked by towering square towers, with volutes and turrets abounding—is particularly audacious.

► ACIBECHARÍA FACADE OF THE CATEDRAL METROPOLITANA DE SANTIAGO

